

Ultimate Guide to Trade Privacy 2025

Trade Privacy Guide

A practical manual for companies that need to understand where public trade records create exposure, how removal windows work, and what to document before filing requests.

Audience: Founders, operations leaders, import teams, and privacy owners handling supplier visibility risk.

What This Resource Covers

- Where public shipment records can expose customers, suppliers, routes, and buying patterns.
- Which evidence to gather before asking CBP, a trade-data platform, or a search platform to review exposed records.
- How to track coverage windows after removal so the same exposure does not quietly reappear.

Why this guide exists

Trade privacy work is easy to underestimate because the sensitive data rarely looks like a password or a bank account number. A supplier name, consignee, container route, or product description can still reveal a business relationship that competitors can use. This guide is written for teams that want a calm operating process instead of one-off panic searches.

How to use it

Start by mapping the records that matter most: current suppliers, strategic customers, seasonal routes, and product lines that reveal margin or sourcing strategy. Then use the guide to decide which records need a CBP confidentiality request, which platform pages or search snippets should be reviewed, which relationships should be monitored, and which records can be left alone because they do not create meaningful commercial risk.

What Remova adds

Remova treats removal as an ongoing coverage problem. A filed request is not the finish line, especially when public vessel manifest data, platform indexes, and search snippets move on different schedules. The useful work is keeping a source list, recording dates, tracking platforms that mirror the data, and checking whether new shipments recreate the same exposure under a slightly different spelling.

Before You Use This PDF

- Create a list of customer and supplier names that should not appear together publicly.
- Record the platform, URL, entity name, shipment date, and exposed relationship for each finding.
- Check whether CBP vessel manifest confidentiality is the right path for importer, consignee, exporter, or shipper names and addresses.
- Keep a follow-up calendar because some platforms refresh from new source data after an

initial removal.

- Separate urgent competitive exposure from low-risk historical records so the team does not waste effort.

Fact-Check Notes

- Source context: 19 CFR 103.31 allows publication of vessel manifest fields and provides a confidentiality process for importer, consignee, exporter, and shipper names and addresses.
- CBP states that vessel manifest information may be shared with paid subscribers unless a confidentiality request is granted.

Related Links

- Sensitive data protection: <https://www.removal.org/features/sensitive-data-protection>
- AI privacy articles: <https://www.removal.org/blog/category/privacy>
- Resources hub: <https://www.removal.org/resources>

Canonical page: <https://www.removal.org/resources/ultimate-guide-trade-privacy-2025>